

Levy 2006 RG Notes

Levy, Jonah D., ed. *The State after Statism: New State Activities in the Age of Liberalization*.

Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 2006.

1 Main Idea

2 General Notes

- From preface: the role of the state has drastically changed in advanced democracies, but the presence of the state (and all it entails) is still very much there. How did these goals change, and what does the state look like in this modern construction?
- Two main conclusions from questioning new state missions across advanced democracies:
 1. “Contemporary developments in the economy, technology, society, and politics are not just challenging existing state activities but also creating demands and opportunities for new state intervention.”
 2. “The spread of a liberal, market logic has been an especially powerful prod to state activism. In short, the move to the market has been, at the same time, a move to and through the state.”
- Shonfield: modern capitalism as “the changing balance of public and private power,” characterized by growth of public intervention in five areas (all quotes):
 1. Management of the economic system
 2. Keynesian demand stimulus, the welfare state, and expanded public expenditures
 3. The “taming” of the “violence of the market” in the private sector, thanks to government regulation, planning, and inter-firm cooperation
 4. Policies to increase innovation and worker training
 5. The pursuit of intellectual coherence through long-term planning
- Broad shift in state activities from “market-steering” to “market-supporting,” with specific focuses (in this volume) on regulation, welfare, and labor policies

3 Important Specific Factual Claims

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4 Connections

- Transition of institutional goals is almost directly linked to Huntington's theory of modernization – emergence of new goals and institutions to achieve those goals

5 My Critiques

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